

Carnegie Hall 2027 Family Meeting Packet

Ashley Bands • September 1, 2026

A plain-language record of the opportunity, tonight's commitment, the family cost boundary, cancellation and FRP information, and what happens next.

\$50

OPENS TONIGHT

Conditional deposit due Friday, September 4. It is refundable until Ashley reaches the performer threshold and pays the WorldStrides group deposit.

\$2,000

FAMILY CEILING

Ashley will not ask a participating family to pay more than \$2,000 under this commitment. It is not a bill due tonight.

\$500

OUR GOAL

Ashley will work to move the family total toward \$500 through significant outside support. This is ambitious and is not guaranteed.

The trip is currently planning around \$2,500 per traveler, excluding personal spending. That is an estimate used to build the trip and funding plan, not another family ask.

THE OPPORTUNITY

Ashley was selected - and now the plan has to become real

- Ashley Concert Band and Wind Ensemble were selected for the National Band & Orchestra Festival at Carnegie Hall.
- Working travel dates are March 23-26, 2027, with both performances on Thursday, March 25.
- The intended educational plan includes Carnegie performances and an AIM master class, Broadway, Statue of Liberty and Ellis Island, the Empire State Building or another structured activity, charter transportation, three hotel nights, and selected meals.
- The final itemized quote, adult pricing, exact inclusions, and any below-minimum ensemble surcharge are still being finalized.

PARTICIPATION

The trip can move forward in one of two ways

40 + 40

Both ensembles

- At least 40 confirmed Wind Ensemble performers
- At least 40 confirmed Concert Band performers
- Two separate Carnegie performances

50

Wind Ensemble-centered

- At least 50 Mr. Parker-approved performers
- Current Wind Ensemble performers are preapproved
- Concert Band students may be added based on instrumentation and readiness
- An unapproved Concert Band student receives the \$50 deposit back

WHAT TONIGHT MEANS

Serious intent now; final contract next

- The form is an initial family intent acknowledgement with typed parent and student signatures. It is not the final trip contract.
- A serious yes tells Ashley it may rely on that response when deciding whether to pay the nonrefundable WorldStrides group deposit.
- A family is agreeing that it intends to participate if its total responsibility is no more than \$2,000.
- If the eventual family responsibility would exceed \$2,000, Ashley must return to families for a new decision. Tonight's acknowledgement does not authorize a higher family obligation.
- The final participation agreement will follow after the performance path and vendor deposit decision, and before the next major family payment.

DATE	WORKING MAXIMUM	MEANING
September 4	\$50	Conditional deposit
September 15	up to \$450	Working first payment
October 15	up to \$500	Working second payment
November 15	up to \$500	Working third payment
December 15	up to \$500	Working final payment

Only the \$50 is open now. The later amounts are a maximum working model and do not become active until Ashley issues the final family agreement and payment instructions. Confirmed outside support can reduce them.

What happens when an individual student withdraws

1 Before Ashley pays WorldStrides

The conditional \$50 is refundable. If the performer threshold is not reached or Ashley does not proceed, Hannah Hales authorizes the Booster refund.

2 After Ashley pays the group deposit

The \$50 becomes nonrefundable and remains credited to the student's trip balance. No later family payment should be collected until the final agreement and written withdrawal rules are issued.

3 After final registration

The final family agreement, WorldStrides cancellation bands, and the group's FRP election control the remaining financial result.

Current standard cancellation bands without FRP

CANCELLATION DATE	CURRENT WORLDSTRIDES CONSEQUENCE
Through November 22, 2026	\$225 per person plus other nonrefundable fees
November 23, 2026-January 6, 2027	25% of the program price plus nonrefundable fees
January 7-February 6, 2027	50% of the program price plus nonrefundable fees
February 7, 2027 or later	No refund

These are the current WorldStrides group-billed individual-cancellation bands when FRP has not been elected. WorldStrides sends group-billed refunds to the Program Leader; the Ashley High School Band Boosters then distribute and reconcile family refunds.

OPTIONAL PROTECTION

Full Refund Program (FRP)

Under the current terms, FRP can protect amounts paid when cancellation happens at least one day before departure, minus the FRP enrollment fee and other nonrefundable fees.

WHAT IS KNOWN	WHAT ASHLEY IS CONFIRMING
• The preliminary estimate is \$279 per covered traveler. • The FRP fee becomes nonrefundable after 24 hours. • FRP is not a promise that every dollar, fee, or outside travel arrangement will be returned.	• Final Ashley price and election deadline • Whether group billing requires the entire group or permits individual travelers to elect • Exactly which local Ashley payments and nonrefundable amounts are protected • When the charge must be paid on group 150783

THE SHARED CAMPAIGN

Moving the family total toward \$500 starts tonight

- Moving the family total toward \$500 will require a significant shared campaign beginning tonight. No gift, grant, scholarship, media placement, or lower family total is guaranteed yet.
- Introduce Mr. Parker to an employer, business, corporate partner, foundation, civic group, arts supporter, or major donor.
 - Open a door to local media or a community leader who can help tell the Carnegie and seven-year rebuilding story.
 - Help with outreach, events, campaign communications, and donor follow-up.
 - Respond promptly to deadlines even if your family cannot add volunteer capacity.

Carnegie deposits, payments, and sponsorships stay separate from Marching Band funding goals and program needs.

These details still require written answers

- Corrected itemized quote, adult pricing, final inclusions, and any ensemble surcharge
- Final family price and payment instructions within the \$2,000 ceiling
- FRP price, election mechanics, deadline, and protected amounts
- Written withdrawal, cancellation, and refund-distribution rules
- School approval, authorized signer, chaperone plan, and economic-access process

PARENT QUESTIONS

Frequently asked questions

Is the trip definitely happening?	Ashley has been selected and is actively planning. The performer threshold, school approval, contract, and WorldStrides deposit still have to close.
Why commit before the final price?	The group size helps determine the final price, and Ashley cannot responsibly risk a nonrefundable vendor deposit based on casual interest. Tonight's decision is bounded at a \$2,000 family ceiling with only the conditional \$50 open now.
What if I need to withdraw?	Before Ashley pays WorldStrides, the \$50 is refundable. After that it is nonrefundable. Later payments follow the final agreement and FRP decision.
Does FRP return every dollar?	No. Current terms describe reimbursement of amounts paid minus the FRP fee and other nonrefundable fees. Ashley is confirming the exact group-billed implementation before offering it.
What if the family responsibility exceeds \$2,000?	Families receive a new decision point. Tonight's acknowledgement does not authorize Ashley to ask a family for more than \$2,000.
Who receives and tracks the money?	The Ashley High School Band Boosters receive the payment through PayPal. Booster President and current Treasurer Hannah Hales owns the trip ledger and refund authorization.
Can fundraising guarantee a \$500 family total?	No. It is the campaign goal, not a promised price. It requires substantial outside support and broad family participation.
When is the final agreement?	After Ashley knows the performance path and pays the applicable vendor deposit, and before the next major family payment. It will contain the final price, payment schedule, withdrawal rules, cancellation terms, and FRP decision.

DUE FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 4

Give Ashley an honest answer

Complete one response per student. A serious yes creates the connected \$50 conditional-deposit charge and lets the family pay immediately at ashleybands.com/carnegie-2027/commit.

Sources and status

- WorldStrides K12 Group Performing Arts Festivals & Bowl Games/Parades Group Terms and Conditions, revised September 2025
- WorldStrides 2026-27 group-billed payment schedule
- Ashley Concert Band and Wind Ensemble acceptance letters, August 24, 2026
- Ashley in-progress Letter of Understanding and preliminary estimate
- Ashley Bands Carnegie Hall 2027 project record, reconciled through September 1, 2026

Planning information as of September 1, 2026. Estimates and open terms are labeled throughout.